GreyWatch Walkthrough 0.2.0

GreyWatch Walkthrough

GreyWatch 0.2.0 - Linux endpoint security. One dashboard for every protection already on this computer. The protections do their own work in the background; GreyWatch reads what they report, explains it in plain words, and asks you for an answer whenever something needs a decision.

This guide walks through every page and every button, including what happens when things are missing or fail. It was written against the real running application, verified screen by screen.

---

1. Start here

What GreyWatch is. A dashboard plus a helper service. The helper service (the **daemon**, running as root) starts and watches the protection tools, writes their events to `/var/lib/greywatch`, and answers requests from the dashboard. The dashboard (this app) reads those files and never changes your system by itself: every state-changing action is written as a request the daemon performs, after you confirm it and, once, after a password prompt.

Where its records live. `/var/lib/greywatch` (system state, written by the daemon) and a user settings file for the look and feel. Nothing you cannot read: every record is plain JSON or plain text.

Fail-safes, in one list:

- **Nothing happens without a confirm.** Every button that changes the machine (lift a block, clear the log, secure-wipe, restore) opens a dialog first that names the exact command. Cancel is always available, and only pressing the confirm runs the command.
- **Privileged actions go through one door.** Requests the daemon must make as root are run by GreyWatch's helper under the system's policy agent, so you see a password prompt naming GreyWatch - never a bare terminal command.
- **A stale status is announced, never hidden.** If the daemon has not reported for too long, the app says so on screen (Settings > Diagnostics shows the age and the sentence "STALE: the daemon pipeline may be wedged") and offers Re-check.
- **A missing record is a quiet placeholder, not a crash.** Empty watchlist, empty lanes, empty quarantines all show a one-line "nothing yet" sentence.
- **An unreadable result never reads as safe.** A protection that has never reported, or whose report could not be read, is shown as UNKNOWN - not green.
- **Every run is traceable.** Scans, quarantine moves, lifts, and your answers are all appended to the Activity Log, and you can copy any row.

Where to start in the app. Open **Overview** (the first sidebar entry). It always answers three questions: what is blocked, what is pending your answer, and what each lane of tools reported last.

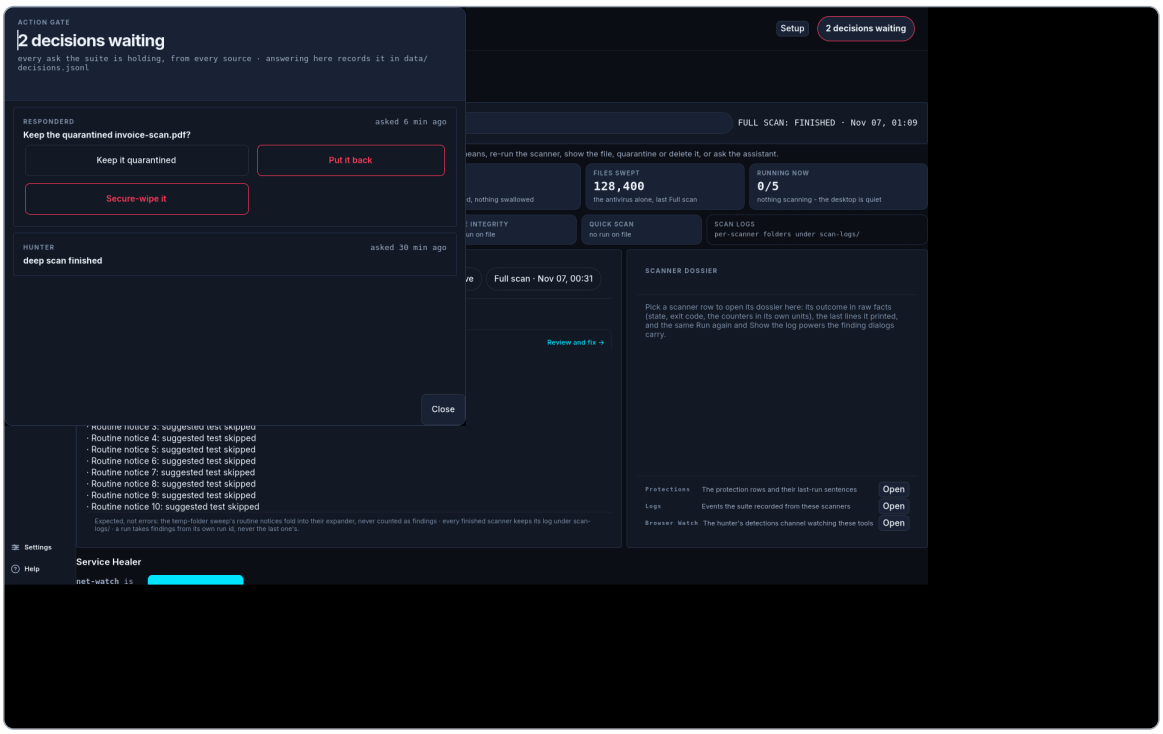
---

2. The window at a glance

The left sidebar carries the six pages, top to bottom:

Sidebar entry	What it is
Overview	Counts, advisories, the two event lanes, the assistant, the action gate
Firewall	Pending decisions, network armor, the block list, the Patch the Planet watchlist
Services	Scans, findings, scanner dossiers, the service healer, the tools table, the registry
Activity Log	Security events, your recorded decisions, active quarantines, full history
Settings	Nine panes: looks, app firewall, notifications, connections, this computer, diagnostics, updates, trusted sites, trusted programs
Help	Using it, what each protection does, ten questions, terminal, about

The header, top right, carries two controls:



decisions-pill.png

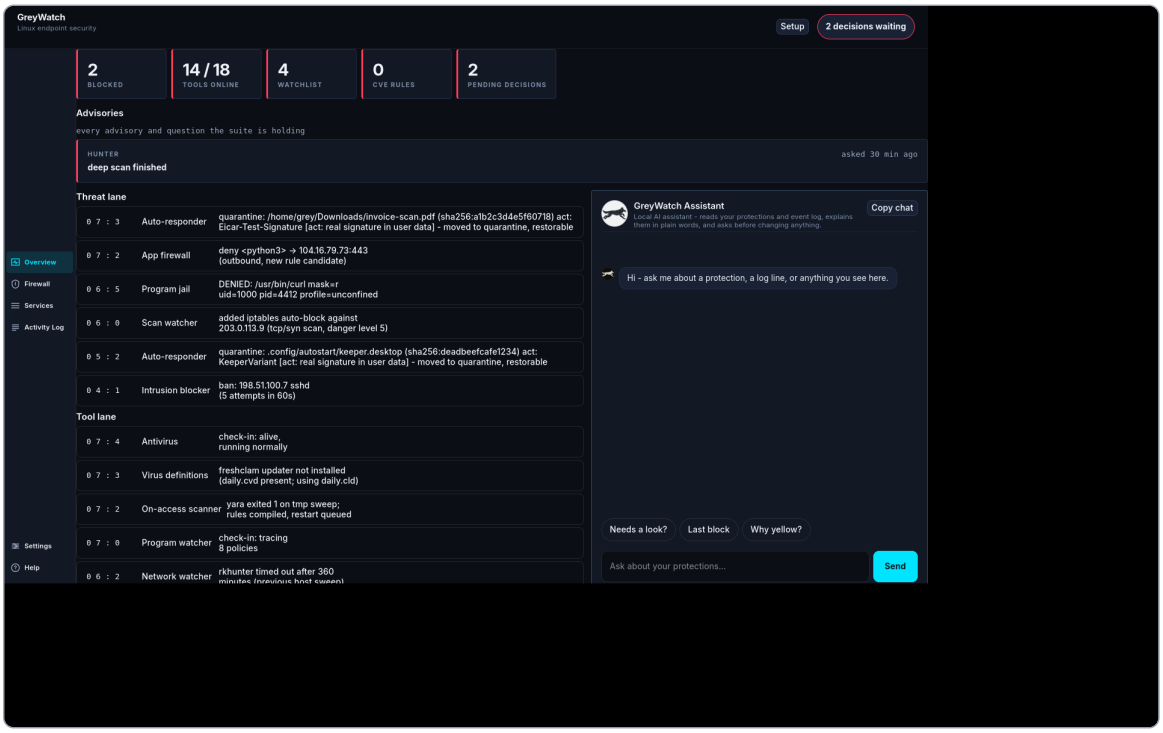
- **Setup** - the guided walkthrough of every protection, for a first run or a re-check.
- **The red pill, "N decisions waiting"** - the total count of questions the suite is holding that you have not answered. Click it: a window opens that lists every pending decision, each with the

same answer buttons the popups show. When nothing is pending the sidebar's Firewall badge is absent and the pill disappears.

The Firewall badge. The small red dot on the Firewall sidebar entry counts what needs you: pending decisions plus current blocks.

---

3. Overview



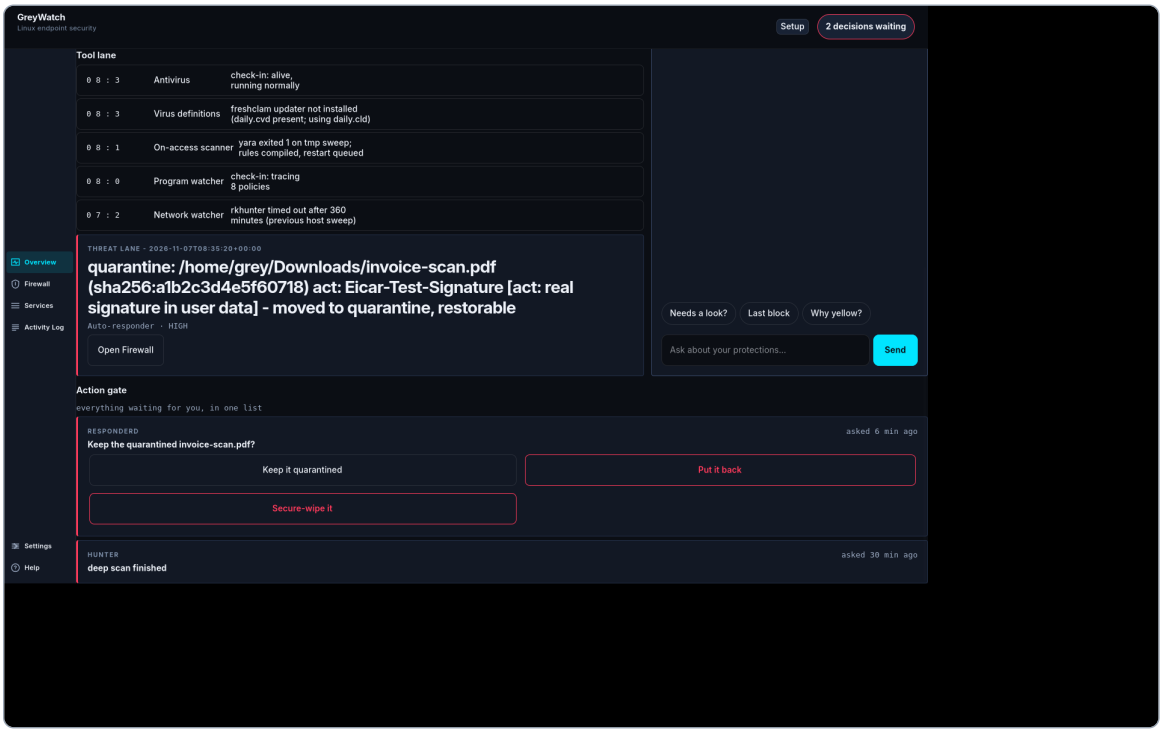
overview.png

The anchor page. From top to bottom:

1. **The ribbon** - five cards: **Blocked** (active IP blocks), **Tools online** ("14 / 18"), **Watchlist** (projects on the Patch the Planet watchlist, or "not read"), **CVE rules** (known-flaw rules loaded), and **Pending decisions** (the same count as the header pill).
2. **Advisories** - every advisory and question the suite is holding, as cards (for example "HUNTER - deep scan finished - asked 35 min ago").
3. **Threat lane** and **Tool lane** - two feeds of recent events. Threat lane rows are things that need an owner's judgement (quarantines, denies, bans); tool lane rows are the protections' own check-ins and notes. Every friendly tool name (Auto-responder, Program jail, Scan watcher, ...) has its real name behind it, one click away in Help > Security Tools.
4. **The metadata card** - click any row: the card appears right below the lanes and scrolls into view, so a click always reads. Threat rows offer that lane's controls on the card; tool rows carry only **Copy details**. Both lanes carry a quiet jump link - **Open Services** for tool events, **Open Firewall** for threat events - so you land on the page that owns that event.
5. **The assistant** - the terminal on the right. Type a question about a protection, a log line, or anything on screen; the assistant reads your event log and protections and answers in plain words. **Copy chat** puts the whole conversation on the clipboard.

6. **The action gate** - the pending questions' answer rows, bottom of the page: each with its option buttons (keep, restore, wipe, note), a running sentence while the helper works, and an exit-code sentence if it does not finish, plus a try again.

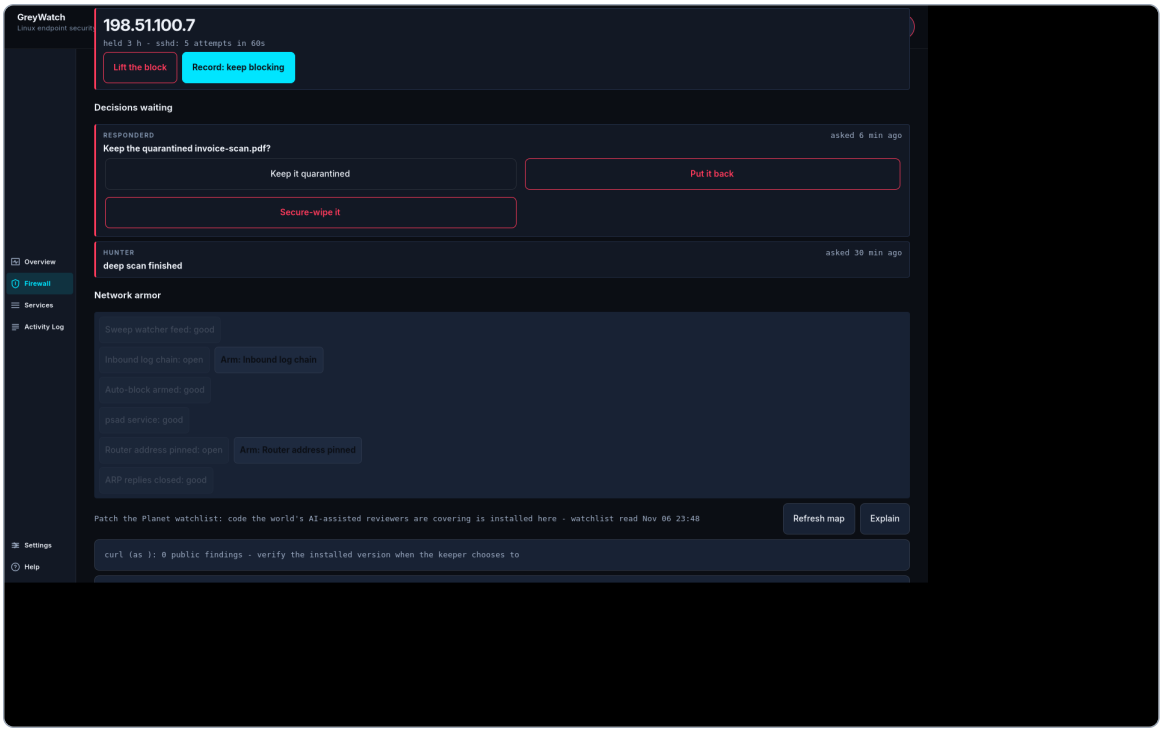
Copy details puts a plain-text digest on the clipboard (severity, tool name and id, the raw line). If the desktop clipboard is unavailable the button simply does nothing - the event is never lost either way, it stays in the log.



overview-row-card.png

---

4. Firewall



firewall.png

The page that owns blocking, decisions, and the network. Top to bottom:

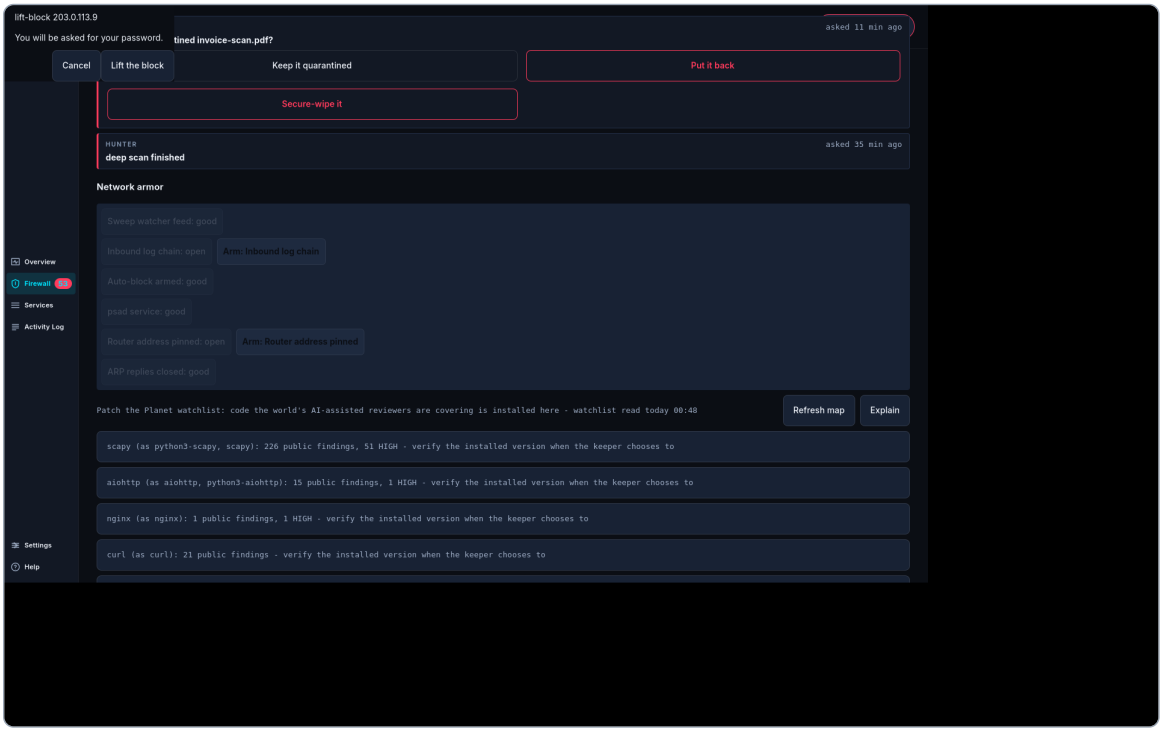
Pending decisions. Each open question is a card, newest first, with the age (“asked 11 min ago”) and its option buttons:

- **Keep it quarantined** - the file stays in quarantine. Safe default; you decide later.
- **Put it back** - restores the file to where it came from. If you did not cause the file, pick this only if you recognise it.
- **Secure-wipe it** - overwrites and deletes the quarantined file. Shown in the danger colour; a confirm dialog names the exact command before anything runs.

Each answer is recorded once to the decisions log, so a question you have answered never reappears.

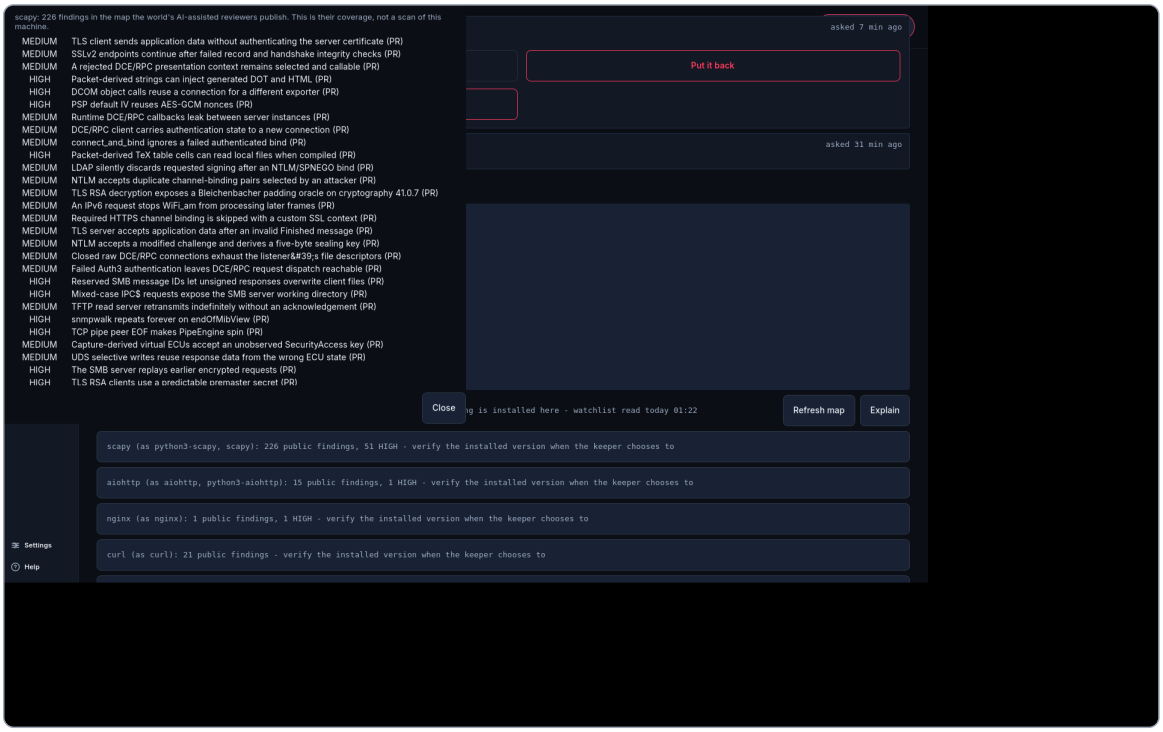
Network armor. One line per protection state: “Sweep watcher feed: good”, “Auto-block armed: good”, “psad service: good”, “ARP replies closed: good” - and two tiles that can be open: **Inbound log chain** and **Router address pinned**. When a tile reads “open”, an **Arm: …** button sits next to it; pressing it requests the change (with its confirm dialog). When a tile reads “good” there is nothing to do, and the button is absent.

The block list. Current IP blocks as cards: address, how long it has been held, the source protection and reason, and two actions: **Lift the block** (opens the confirm dialog - “lift-block 203.0.113.9 / You will be asked for your password.” - and Cancel keeps the block) and **Record: keep blocking**, which writes your decision to keep the block into the decisions log, so the question stops counting as waiting without touching the firewall.



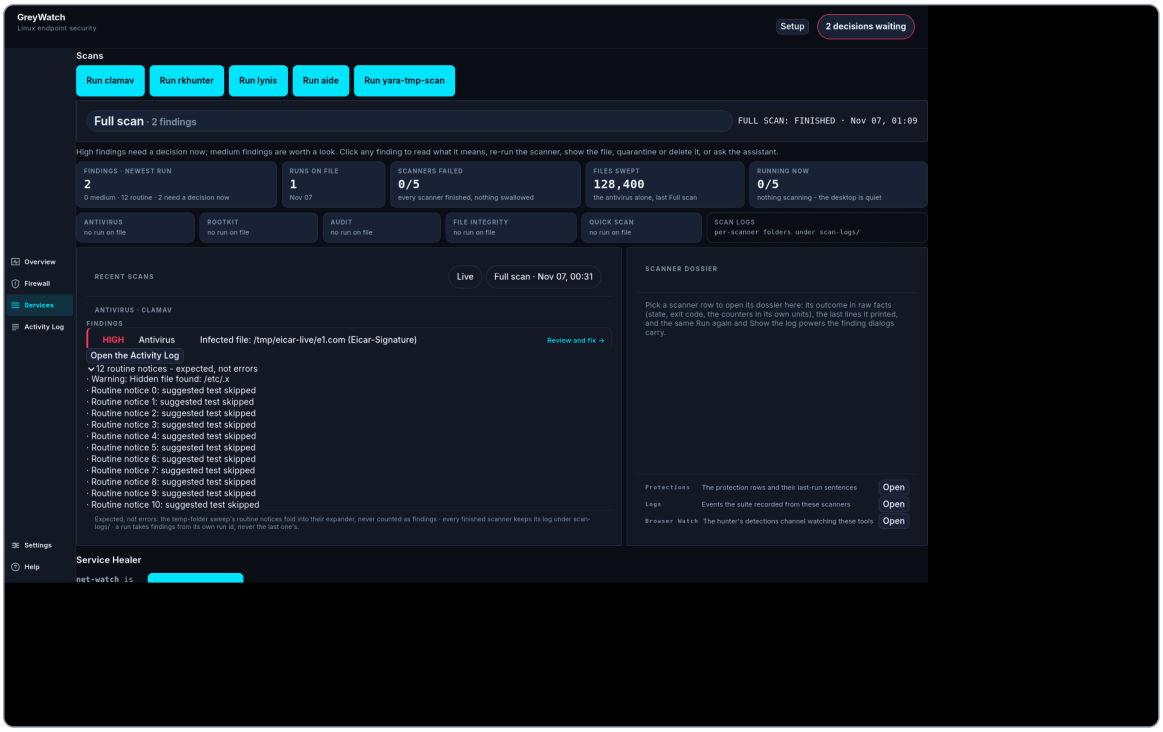
lift-block-confirm.png

Patch the Planet watchlist. “Code the world’s AI-assisted reviewers are covering is installed here.” Rows name each watched project with its installed names, its public finding count, and the HIGH count - for example “scapy (as python3-scapy, scapy): 226 public findings, 51 HIGH - verify the installed version when the keeper chooses to”. Press **Refresh map** to re-read the watchlist now; the stamp on the left says when it was last read. Press **Explain** to ask the assistant for the watch table in plain words. A project row opens its drill-down (what the public findings are and which installed package they map to); close it when done.



watchlist-drilldown.png

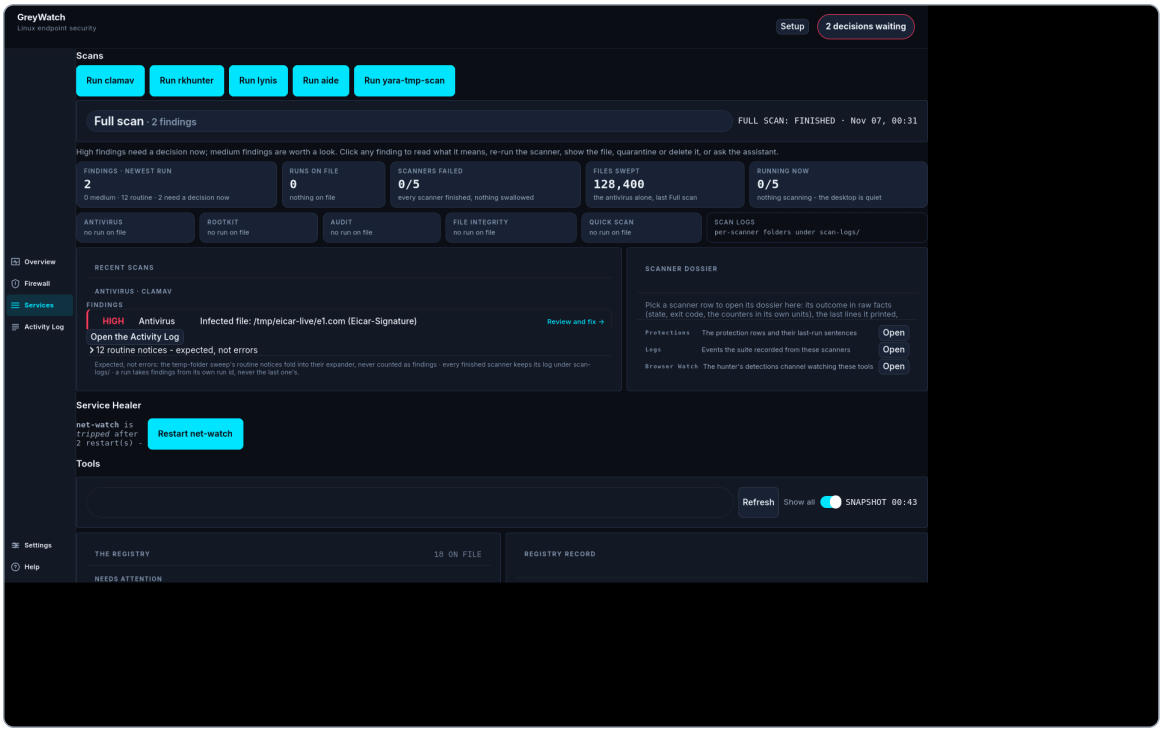
Failsafes on this page. If the watchlist has never been read, the Overview tile says “not read” and the section stays empty instead of inventing numbers; Refresh map fills it. If a project’s installed packages cannot be resolved, the row degrades to the project name alone. Blocks are kept in the blocked-IP ledger (including releases, so you can see what was lifted and why); the ledger is on this page below the rows.



scan-request-no-daemon.png

---

5. Services



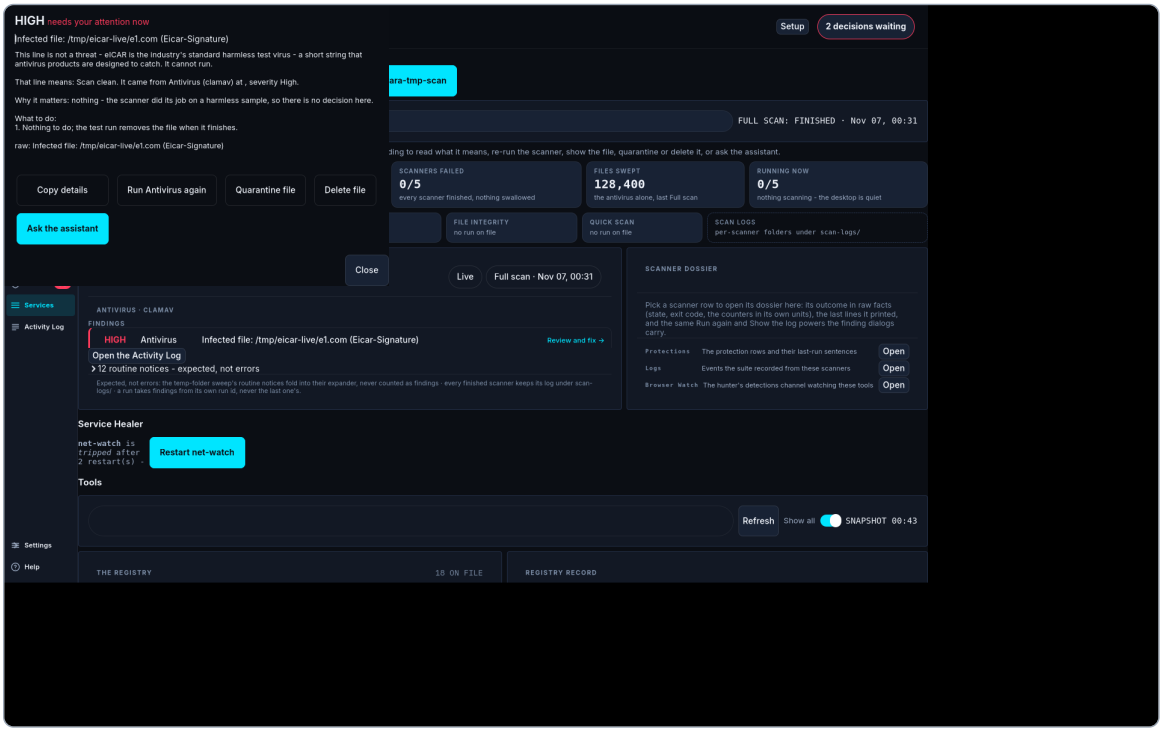
services.png

Everything about scanning and the tools themselves.

The scan run header. A **Live** pill (the current run) and one pill per past run (“Full scan - Nov 07, 00:31”). The banner reads `FULL SCAN: FINISHED - Nov 07, 00:31` or `RUNNING` while scanners work.

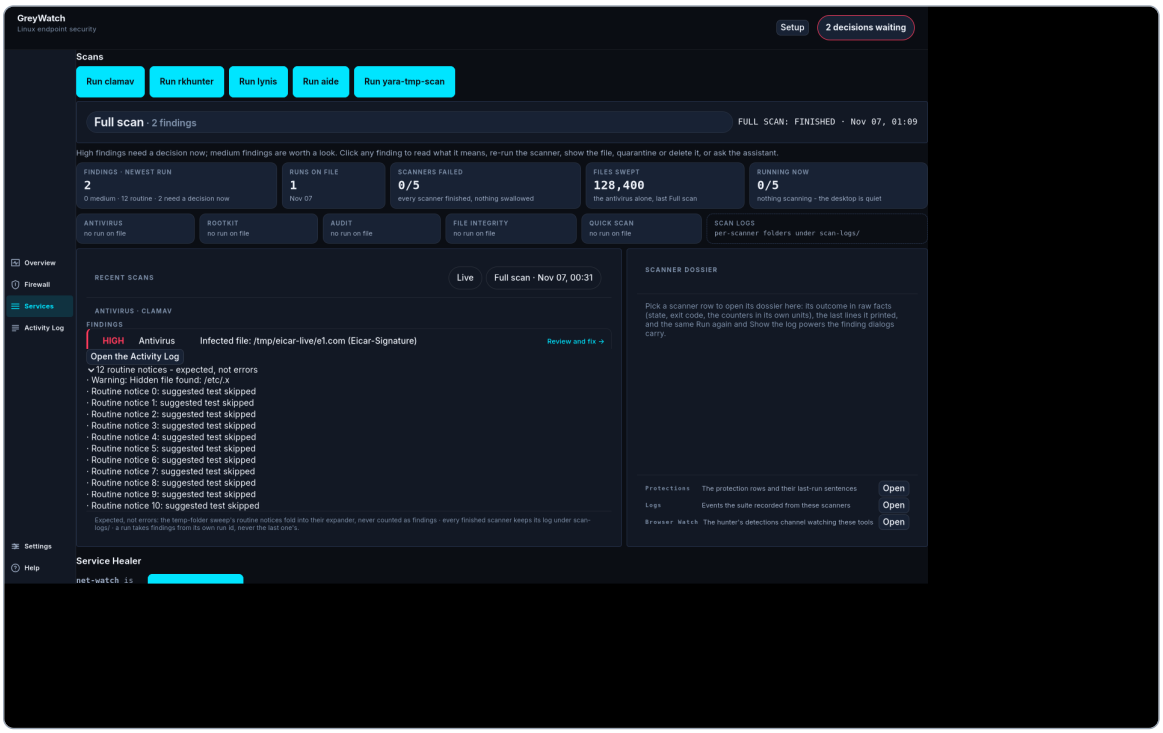
The stat tiles. Scanners failed (0/5, “every scanner finished, nothing swallowed”), **Files swept**, **Running now** (0/5, “nothing scanning - the desktop is quiet”), plus buttons **File integrity**, **Quick scan**, and **Scan logs** (“per-scanner folders under scan-logs/”).

Findings. The run’s findings, most severe first, one row per finding: severity chip (HIGH etc.), the tool (“Antivirus”), the raw line, and **Review and fix >**. Pressing it opens the finding dialog, which explains the line in plain words: what the line is, what it means (“why it matters”), and “what to do” - then the actions: **Copy details**, **Run again**, **Quarantine file**, **Delete file**, **Ask the assistant**, and **Close**. Quarantine and Delete open their own confirm dialogs before anything runs.



finding-dialog.png

Routine notices. The expander under the findings ("12 routine notices - expected, not errors") folds away the scanner notices that are expected and never counted as findings. Click it to open or close. Its caption explains itself: routine notices fold into their expander, every finished scanner keeps its log under scan-logs/, and a run takes findings from its own run id, never the last one's.



routine-expander.png

The scanner dossier. "Pick a scanner row to open its dossier here: its outcome in raw facts (state, exit code, the counters in its own units), the last lines it printed, and the same Run again and Show

the log powers the finding dialogs carry.” Three quick links on the right: **Protections** (the tool rows and their last-run sentences), **Logs** (events the suite recorded from these scanners), **Browser Watch** (the hunter’s detections channel).

The record. Open the Activity Log - every scan event, with a fix card per row.

Service healer. When a protection is tripped after its restarts, the healer says so (“net-watch is tripped after 2 restart(s)”) and offers **Restart net-watch** - a request the daemon performs, with its confirm.

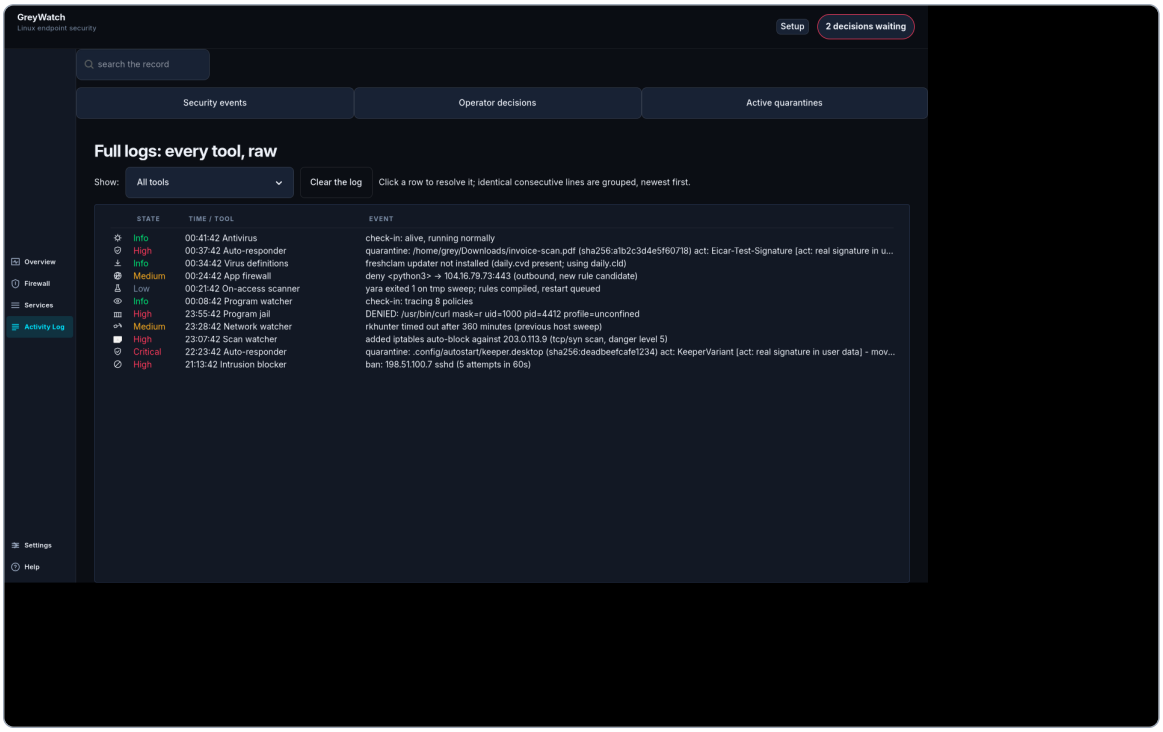
The tools table. Every protection as a row: state chip, last-run sentence, its Pause/Resume and controls (two-lane law: tool controls live here, never next to threat rows). **Refresh** re-reads now; **Show all** toggles hidden/dormant tools into the table; the **SNAPSHOT** stamp right of the switch shows the data’s age. Selecting a row opens its dossier panel, which carries **Open the Activity Log**.

The registry. “THE REGISTRY - 18 ON FILE” beside the **REGISTRY RECORD**: the full list of protections GreyWatch knows, with where each one’s state lives.

Failsafes on this page. If the daemon is absent, a scan press still works: the request is written to a request file the daemon honours (one validated key, written atomically so a half document is never read), the action is recorded in the audit trail, and the page jumps there so you can watch - and then nothing pretends to run. The RUNNING NOW tile keeps its truthful count and the banner keeps its last real state, so a run that never started is never reported as started or finished. When the service returns, it picks the request up. File integrity and quick scan show “no run on file” until their first run. If a scanner was skipped (“no baseline”), the tile says so plainly.

---

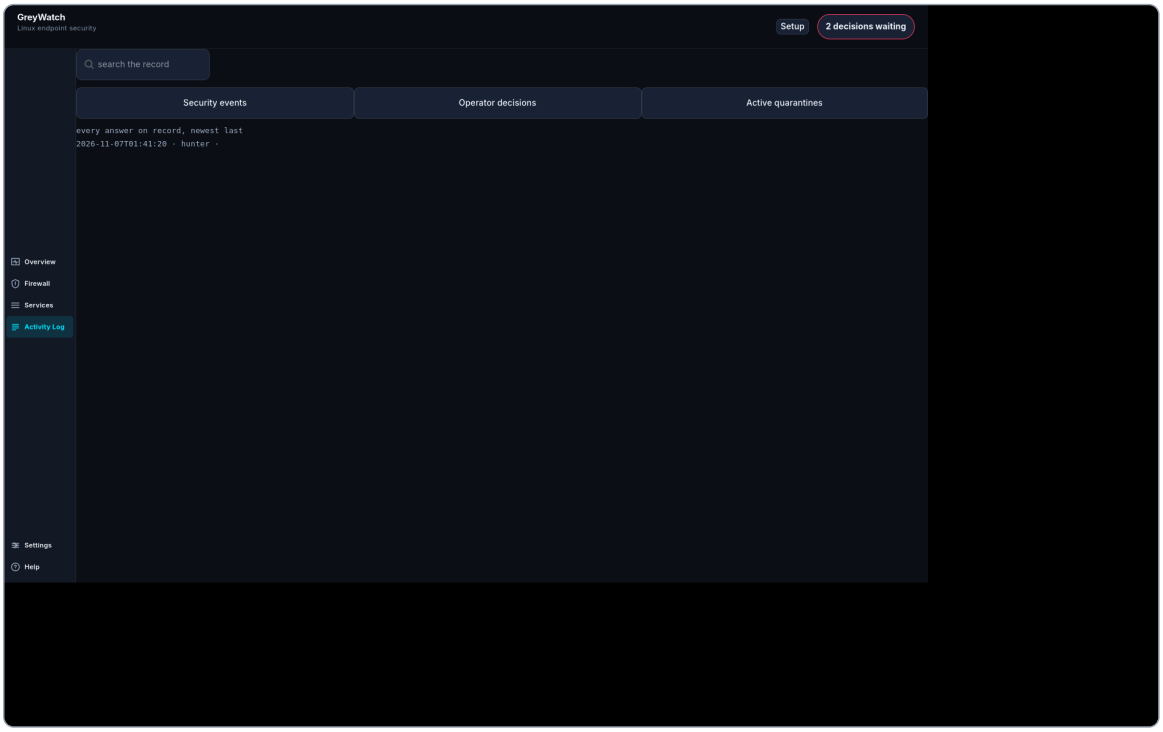
6. Activity Log



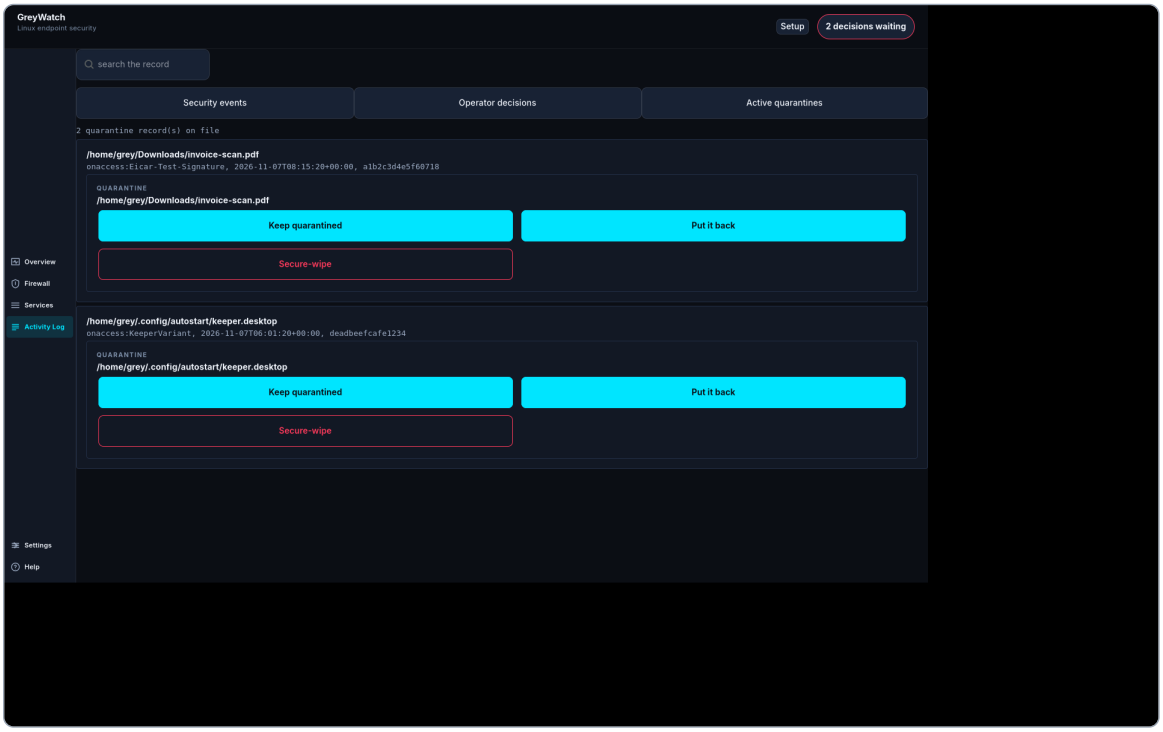
activity-log.png

Three tabs plus the full trail:

Tab	What it lists	What you can do per row
Security events	The events the protections reported, newest first	Click to open the fix card (details copy, lane actions, jump to Firewall or Services); identical consecutive lines are grouped
Operator decisions	“Every answer on record, newest last”: what you answered, when, and with which option	The history of your own answers
Active quarantines	“N quarantine record(s) on file”: original path, detection tag, time, sha256 tag, and the quarantine file	The lifecycle on each record: **Keep quarantined**, **Put it back**, **Secure-wipe** (the danger tone) - each behind its own confirm dialog



decisions-tab.png



quarantine-tab.png

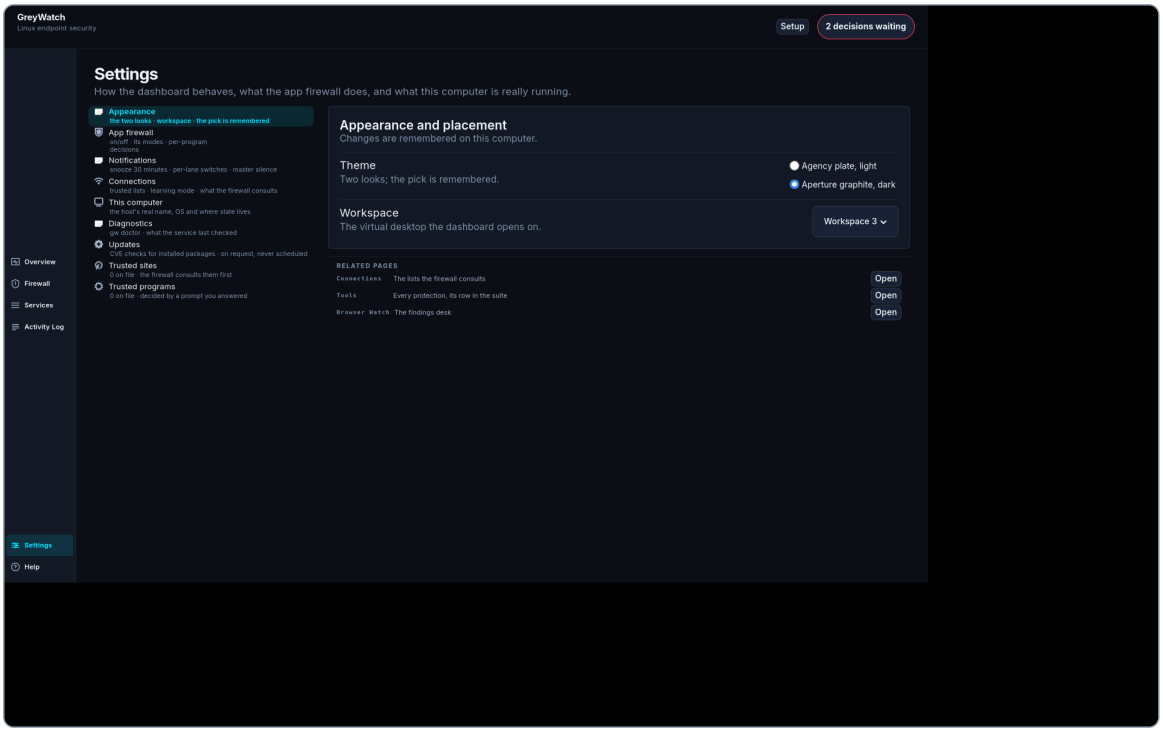
Clear the log erases the event trail - behind its own confirm dialog; press **Cancel** and nothing changes.

Reading habits the page enforces. The status line says it: “Click a row to resolve it; identical consecutive lines are grouped, newest first.” Tooltips on rows carry the full text so nothing is clipped; a search box (“search the record”) narrows the trail, and a tool picker (Show: All tools) narrows it to one protection.

The full log view. Settings-adjacent folder and trail views (“Open the Activity Log” buttons route here from every page that mentions logs) - the same trail, one page, one click away.

---

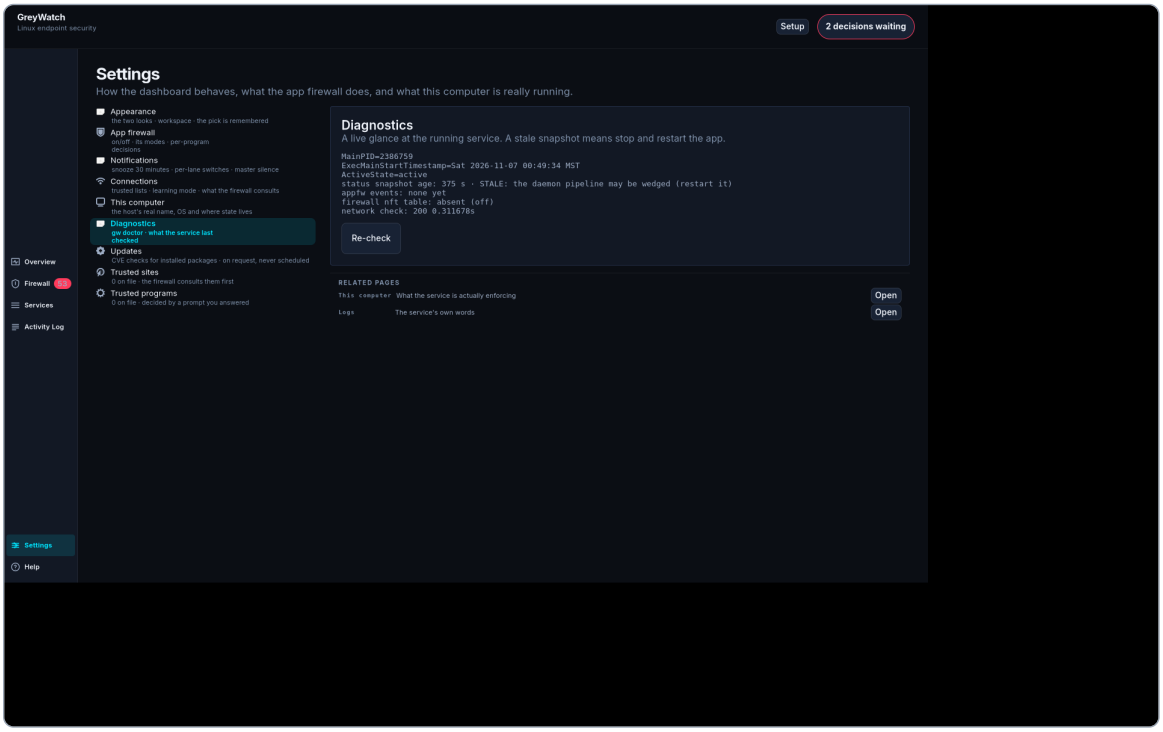
7. Settings



settings.png

Nine panes in the left index. Each pane ends with **RELATED PAGES** links that jump across the app.

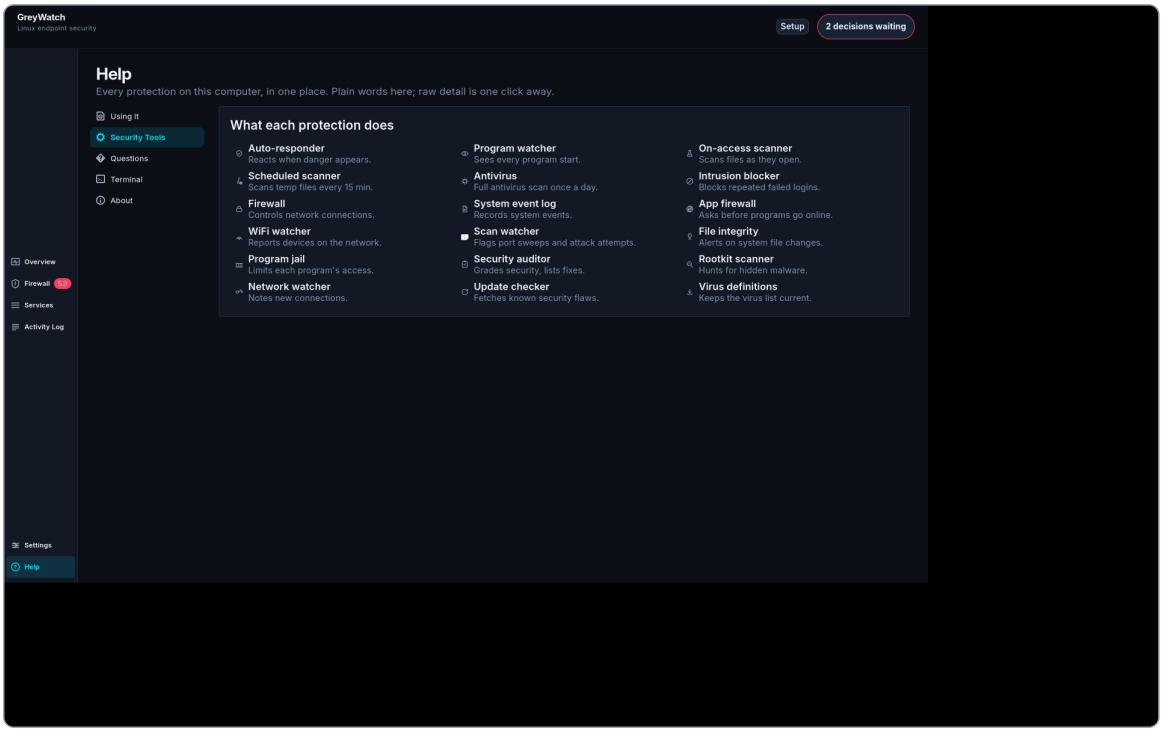
- **Appearance and placement** - two looks: **Agency plate, light** and **Aperture graphite, dark**; the pick is remembered on this computer and restored on the next launch. **Workspace** chooses the virtual desktop the dashboard opens on (1 to 6).
- **App firewall** - the on/off button (“Turn on”), the note of what it decided so far, and **Learning mode** with its duration (15 minutes, one hour, eight hours, or until you stop it): while learning, the firewall records what programs try instead of blocking them.
- **Desktop notifications** - the master switch (“The total switch: off silences every lane at once”), **Snooze 30 minutes** (“then they come back by themselves”), plus per-lane switches: **Firewall deny popups** and **Critical event popups**. “Scans and events stay recorded even when their popups are quiet.”
- **Connections seen while learning** - the learned list with **Trust this program**, **Trust this site**, **Block this site**, **Clear**. With nothing learned yet the buttons are greyed out and the pane says “Nothing learned yet. Turn learning on under App firewall.” Trusting one here is the same answer the popup would have offered.
- **This computer** - the host’s real name, the OS, and where the state files live.
- **Diagnostics** - the gw doctor output: the service’s MainPID and ActiveState, the status snapshot age, and the STALE sentence when the daemon has not reported in a while (“the daemon pipeline may be wedged - restart it”), with **Re-check** to re-read right now.
- **Updates** - CVE checks for installed packages, on request, never scheduled.
- **Trusted sites** - the list the firewall consults first, with its count shown in the index.
- **Trusted programs** - “These connect without asking. Pick from the list, or browse for the program you mean”: a program picker, **Browse...**, and **Trust program**; **Remove program** takes one out. Empty state: “Nothing trusted yet. Programs you trust appear here.”



diagnostics.png

---

8. Help

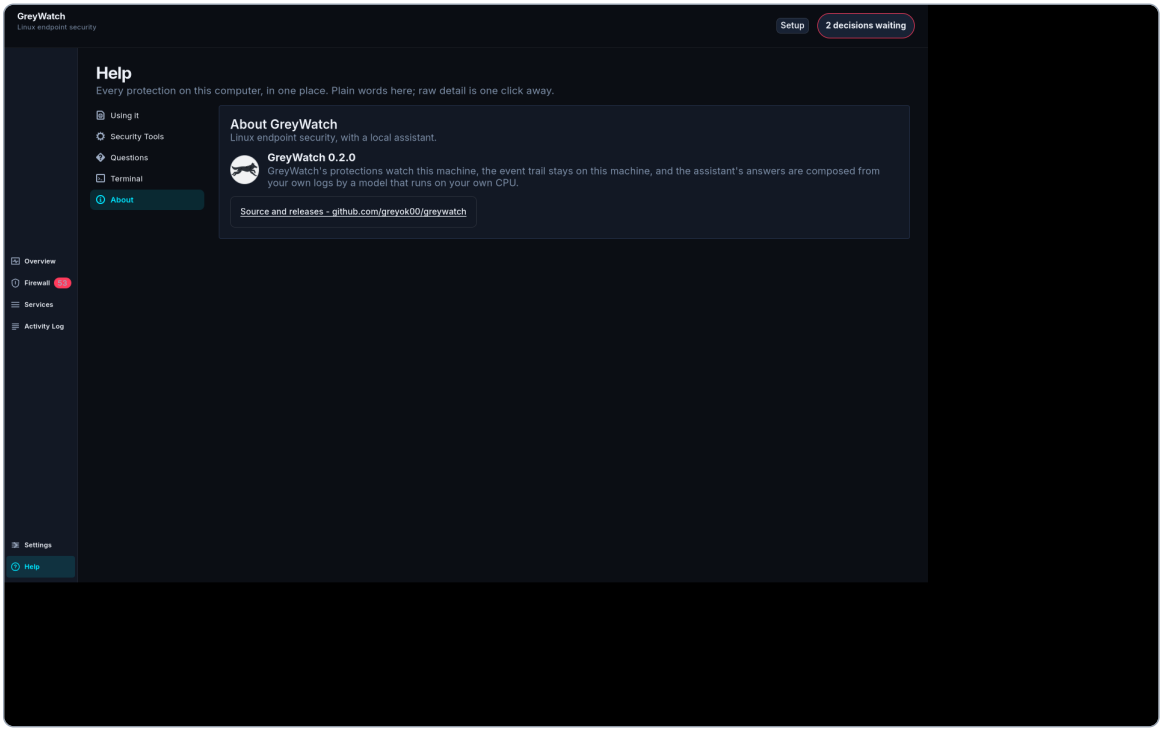


help-tools.png

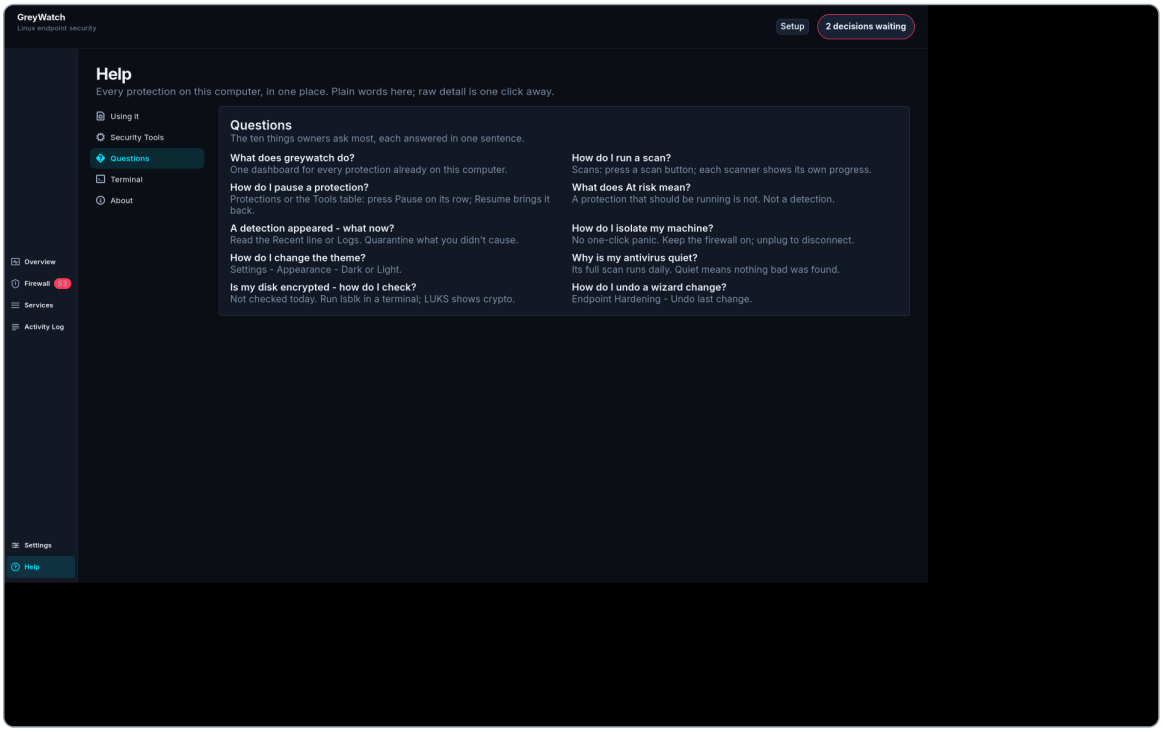
Five subpages, plain words, no jargon:

- **Using it** - the orientation: which page owns which question.

- **Security Tools** - “What each protection does”: all eighteen, one line each (Auto-responder - reacts when danger appears; Program watcher - sees every program start; On-access scanner - scans files as they open; Antivirus - full scan once a day; Firewall - controls network connections; App firewall - asks before programs go online; Program jail - limits each program’s access; File integrity - alerts on system file changes; Rootkit scanner - hunts for hidden malware; Integrity blocker, Intrusion blocker - blocks repeated failed logins; Scan watcher - flags port sweeps and attack attempts; Security auditor - grades security and lists fixes; Scheduled scanner - scans temp files every 15 min; System event log - records system events; Network watcher - notes new connections; WiFi watcher - reports devices on the network; Update checker
    - fetches known security flaws; Virus definitions - keeps the virus list current).
- **Questions** - the ten things owners ask most, each answered in one sentence (What does GreyWatch do; How do I pause a protection; A detection appeared - what now; How do I change the theme; Is my disk encrypted; How do I run a scan; What does “At risk” mean; How do I isolate my machine; Why is my antivirus quiet; How do I undo a wizard change).
- **Terminal** - what to run when you want the raw view without the window.
- **About** - the version, the one-paragraph promise (protections watched, event trail stays on this machine, the assistant’s answers composed from your own logs by a model that runs on your own CPU), and the **Source and releases** link.



about.png



help-questions.png

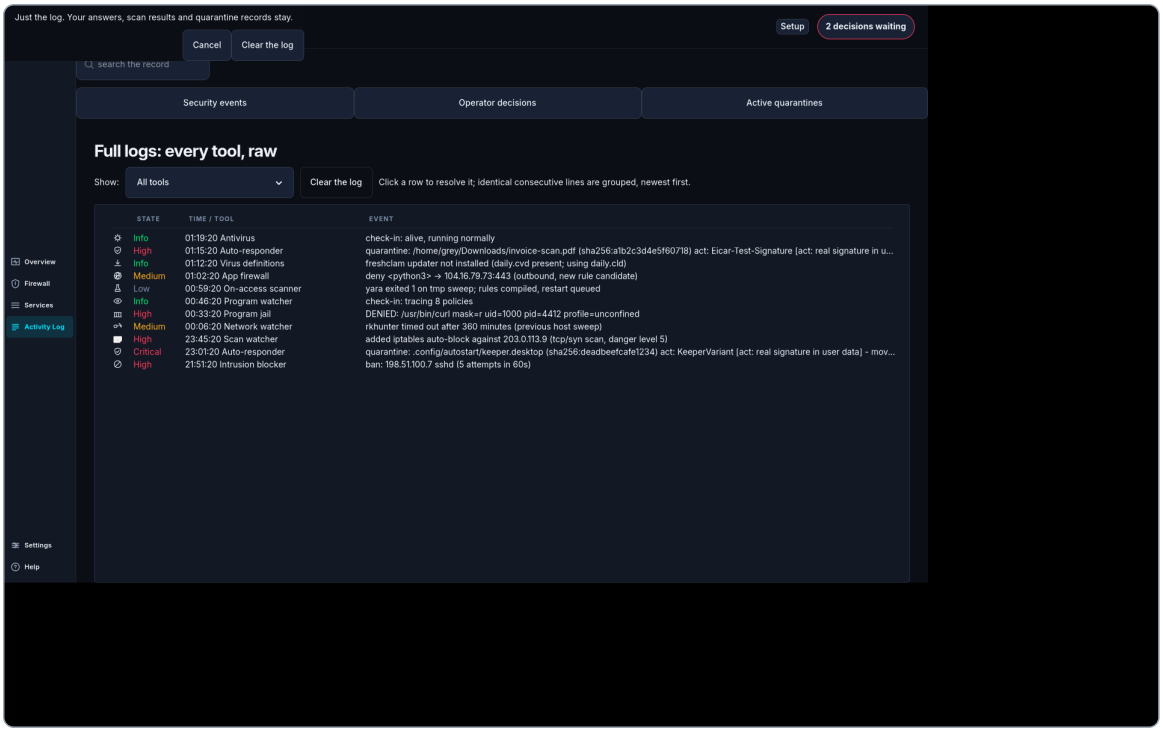
---

9. The assistant

The assistant terminal (Overview, right side; also reachable from finding dialogs with **Ask the assistant**) is the local chat brain: it reads the same published records the pages read, explains a line in plain words, and can run only the same manual paths the buttons carry (whitelisted intents + the audit trail), never its own inventions. If a reply fails, the panel offers **Retry** - the question is kept, nothing is lost; **Copy chat** keeps the transcript.

---

10. FAQ



clear-log-confirm.png

Is anything sent anywhere? No. The event trail stays on this machine. The assistant's answers are composed on this machine, by a model that runs on your own CPU.

Something needs a decision. Where do I answer it? Three doors lead to the same answers: the header pill ("N decisions waiting"), the Firewall page's decision cards, and the action gate at the bottom of Overview. Answering with any door records it once.

I pressed a row and nothing seemed to happen. Look just below the lanes: the metadata card paints there and the page scrolls it into view. If you still see nothing, the row you pressed had already been replaced by a newer paint (the feeds refresh on their own); press it again.

A scan press did nothing - the scanner never started. The request was written, but the helper service is not running to perform it. Check Settings > Diagnostics: it shows whether the service is active and how old its last report is. Start the service, then press the scan again; the request the app wrote is safe to repeat and never runs twice.

Something says "At risk". What does that mean? It is the colour a protection carries when it should be running but is not. It is not a detection - it means "look at this row".

A HIGH finding appeared. What now? Open Services, press **Review and fix** on the row. The dialog explains the line in plain words, tells you why it matters and what to do, and carries the actions (copy, run again, quarantine, delete, ask the assistant). If you did not cause the file, quarantine is the safe move: the file leaves its place but is not destroyed, and you can restore or secure-wipe it later from the Active quarantines tab.

Something keeps asking for my password. Is that the app? Privileged requests all go through one helper under the system's policy agent; the prompt names GreyWatch and the command it wants to run. If a prompt names something else, cancel it and check Diagnostics.

How do I pause a protection? Services > the tools table: Pause on its row. Resume brings it back. The row's state chip will read what happened.

How do I undo a change I made in the wizard? Help > Terminal explains the undo path; Settings keeps your picks remembered, and every change you confirmed is recorded in the Operator decisions tab of the Activity Log.

The status looks frozen. Settings > Diagnostics: if the snapshot age reads STALE, press **Re-check**. If it stays stale, the daemon pipeline may be wedged - restart the service, and the app will recover its view by itself.

Can I get the raw lines without the window? Yes. Help > Terminal lists the file paths and commands: the event trail under `/var/lib/greywatch` is plain JSON Lines you can read with any tool.

Why does the watchlist say "not read"? The Patch the Planet map has not been read on this machine yet. Press **Refresh map** on the Firewall page and it fills in; the stamp shows when.

What happens on a machine with no desktop notifications? Nothing breaks: the switches stay off, events stay recorded, and the counters keep counting. Popups are a convenience lane, never the record.

This guide describes GreyWatch 0.2.0 exactly as shipped. Every claim above was checked against the running application screen by screen; screenshots in the shots folder show each step.